

Abstract Algebra – Dummit & Foote

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Part I

Group Theory

1 Introduction to Groups

1.1 Axioms

If $\star$ is a function on set G such that $\star : G \times G \rightarrow G$, then $\star$ is a **binary operation** on G .

- Associative if $\forall a, b \in G, a \star (b \star c) = (a \star b) \star c$
- Commutative if $\forall a, b \in G, a \star b = b \star a$

A **group** is an ordered pair $(G, \star)$ such that

1. $\star$ is associative
2. Existence of identity: $\exists e \in G$ such that $\forall a \in G, a \star e = e \star a = a$
3. Existence of inverse: $\forall a \in G, \exists a^{-1} \in G$ such that $a \star a^{-1} = a^{-1} \star a = e$

*A group is **Abelian (commutative)** if $\forall a, b \in G, a \star b = b \star a$

E.g. $\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$ are groups under $+$ with identity $e = 0$ and inverse $a^{-1} = -a$. But $\mathbb{Z} - \{0\}$ is not a group under $\times$ because inverses are not guaranteed to exist.

Let $(G, \star)$ be a group, and $x \in G$. The **order** of x is the smallest positive integer n such that $x^n = 1$, and is denoted $|x|$. If no positive powers of x is 1, $|x| = \infty$.

- In the additive group $\mathbb{Z}/9\mathbb{Z}$, $\bar{6}$ has order 3, since $\bar{6} + \bar{6} + \bar{6} = \bar{18} = \bar{0}$.
- In the multiplicative group $\mathbb{R} - \{0\}$, -1 has order 2 since $(-1)^2 = 1$.

1.2 Dihedral Groups

For each $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+, n \geq 3$, let D_{2n} be the set of symmetries of a regular n -gon. E.g. $s \in D_{2n}$ might be a rotation of $2\pi/n$ around the n -gon.

$|D_{2n}| = 2n$, so we call D_{2n} the **dihedral group of order $2n$** .

Any symmetry can be written in terms of rotations (r) and reflections (s) alone, e.g. for $n = 12$,

$$(sr^9)(sr^6) = s(r^9s)r^6 = s(sr^{-9})r^6 = s^2r^{-3} = r^9$$

S is a set of generators of G if any element of G can be written as a finite product of the elements of S . This is notated:

$$G = \langle S \rangle$$

For the dihedral group, $S = \{s, r\}$. The equations in G that the generators satisfy are called **relations** in G . For D_{2n} , the relations are $r^n = 1$, $s^2 = 1$, and $rs = sr^{-1}$.

If G is generated by S , and there exists a collection of relations $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_m$, then these generators and relations are called the **presentation of G** :

$$G = \langle S \mid R_1, R_2, \dots, R_m \rangle$$

For the dihedral group, $D_{2n} = \langle r, s \mid r^n = s^2 = 1, rs = sr^{-1} \rangle$.

1.3 Symmetric Groups

Let S_Ω be the bijection from Ω to itself (permutation). S_Ω is a group under the function composition $\circ$.

- Call $(S_\Omega, \circ)$ the **symmetric group** on set Ω .
- If $\Omega = \{1, 2, 3, \dots, n\}$, then we denote S_Ω as S_n , the **symmetric group of degree n** .
- $(S_n, \circ)$ has degree $n!$ ($n!$ elements).

We can represent S_n in a cycle decomposition, grouping disjoint cycles. E.g.

$$(a_1 \ a_2 \ \dots \ a_m)(a_{m_1+1} \ a_{m_1+2} \ \dots \ a_{m_2}) \cdots (a_{m_{k-1}+1} \ a_{m_{k-1}+2} \ \dots \ a_{m_k})$$

Meaning that a_1 goes to a_2 , a_{m_1+1} goes to a_{m_1+2} , etc. Values such that $\sigma(a_i) = a_i$ aren't written. For example, for $\sigma \in S_3$ with $\sigma(1) = 1$, $\sigma(2) = 3$, and $\sigma(3) = 2$, the cycle decomposition is

$$(2 \ 3)$$

1.4 Matrix Groups

First, we need to define a field. A field is a set F with 2 binary operators $+$ and $\cdot$ such that

1. $(F, +)$ and $(F - \{0\}, \cdot)$ are Abelian groups
2. The distribution law holds:

$$a \cdot (b + c) = (a \cdot b) + (a \cdot c) \quad \forall a, b, c \in F$$

Define the **general linear group of degree n** :

$$GL_n(F) = \{A \mid A \text{ is a } n \times n \text{ matrix with entries from } F, \text{ and } \det(A) \neq 0\}$$

- Since $\det(A) = 0$, $GL_n(F)$ is closed under matrix multiplication.
- Matrix products are associative.
- $\det(A) \neq 0$ iff. A has an inverse.

Thus, $GL_n(F)$ is a group under matrix multiplication.

1.5 The Quaternion Group

Simple enough:

$$\begin{aligned}
 Q_8 &= \{1, -1, i, -i, j, -j, k, -k\} \\
 1 \cdot a &= a \cdot 1 = a \\
 (-1) \cdot a &= a \cdot (-1) = -a \\
 i \cdot i &= j \cdot j = k \cdot k = -1 \\
 i \cdot j &= k, \quad j \cdot k = i, \quad k \cdot i = j \\
 j \cdot i &= -k, \quad k \cdot j = -i, \quad i \cdot k = -j
 \end{aligned}$$

$(Q_8, \cdot)$ is a non-Abelian group of order 8.

1.6 Homomorphisms and Isomorphisms

Let $(G, \star)$ and $(H, \diamond)$ be groups. A map $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ such that

$$\phi(x \star y) = \phi(x) \diamond \phi(y)$$

is a **homomorphism**.

- “A map that reflects the group structure of the domain and codomain.”

$\phi : G \rightarrow H$ is called an **isomorphism** if

1. ϕ is a homomorphism
2. ϕ is a bijection

Can also say: G and H are isomorphic; G and H are of the same isomorphism type; $G \cong H$.

I.e. G and H are the “same group” except the elements and operators are written differently (think abstract).

If $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ is an isomorphism, then

1. $|G| = |H|$
2. G is Abelian iff. H is Abelian
3. $\forall x \in G, |x| = |\phi(x)|$

1.7 Group Actions

A group action from group G on set A is a map from $G \times A$ to A satisfying

1. $g_1 \cdot (g_2 \cdot a) = (g_1 g_2) \cdot a \quad \forall g_1, g_2 \in G, \forall a \in A$
 2. $1 \cdot a = a \quad \forall a \in A$
-

Let G act on A . For each $g \in G$, define σ_g to be the map

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma_g : A &\rightarrow A \\ \sigma_g(a) &= g \cdot a\end{aligned}$$

1. For each $g \in G$, σ_g is a permutation of A .
2. The map from G to S_A defined by $g \mapsto \sigma_g$ is a homomorphism.

I.e. every $g \in G$ acts as a permutation of A in a way consistent with the group operation in G .

Group actions treat $g \in G$ to be functions, sort of.

2 Subgroups

A subset H of a group H is a **subgroup** of G if

1. $H \neq \emptyset$
2. H is closed under products and inverses. I.e. $x, y \in H$ implies $x^{-1} \in H$ and $xy \in H$.

This is denoted $H \leq G$, or if $H \neq G$, $H < G$.

I.e. a subgroup is a subset of G that is also a group w.r.t the binary operation defined on G . A subgroup must thus contain the identity operator.

Every G has two subgroups: $H = G$ and $H = \{1\}$ (trivial subgroup).

A simpler subgroup criterion: a subset H of a group G is a subgroup of G iff.

1. $H \neq \emptyset$
2. $\forall x, y \in H, xy^{-1} \in H$

2.1 Centralizers and Normalizers, Stabilizers and Kernels

Let A be a subset of G .

The **centralizer of A in G** is the set of elements of G that commute with every element of A .

$$C_G(A) = \{g \in G \mid gag^{-1} = a, \forall a \in A\}$$

- For an Abelian group G , $C_G(A) = G, \forall A \subseteq G$.
- For the quaternion group, $C_{Q_8}(\{i\}) = \{\pm 1, \pm i\}$

The **center of G** is the set of elements of G commuting with every element of G .

$$Z(G) = C_G(G) = \{g \in G \mid gx = xg, \forall x \in G\}$$

The **normalizer of A in G** is the set of elements of G that commutes with the entire set A .

$$N_G(A) = \{g \in G \mid gAg^{-1} = A\}$$

This is a looser criterion than the centralizer, since order within A doesn't matter. Formally, if $g \in C_G(A)$, then $gag^{-1} = a$ for all $a \in A$, so $C_G(A) \leq N_G(A)$.

For an Abelian group G , which has the commutation property already, $C_G(A) = N_G(A) = Z(G) = G$, for any subset $A \subseteq G$.

If G is a group action on set S , and $s \in S$, the **stabilizer of s in G** is

$$G_s = \{g \in G \mid g \cdot s = s\}$$

- $1 \in G_s$
- If $y \in G_s$, then $y^{-1} \in G_s$.

$$\begin{aligned} s &= 1 \cdot s = (y^{-1}y) \cdot s \\ &= y^{-1} \cdot (y \cdot s) \\ &= y^{-1} \cdot s \end{aligned}$$

- If $x, y \in G_s$, then $xy \in G_s$.

$$\begin{aligned} (xy) \cdot s &= x \cdot (y \cdot s) \\ &= x \cdot s \\ &= s \end{aligned}$$

Thus G_s is a subgroup of the group action G , or $G_s \leq G$.

The **kernel of the action of G on set S** is

$$\{g \in G \mid g \cdot s = s, \forall s \in S\}$$

2.2 Cyclic Subgroups

A possible way to generate a subgroup H of G from an element $x \in G$ is to form the set $H = \{x^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$. Guarantees closure under products and inverses.

A subgroup $H \subseteq G$ is **cyclic** if $\exists x \in H$ such that $H = \{x^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$. I.e. H can be generated by 1 element. Notated $H = \langle x \rangle$. Cyclic groups are Abelian, by properties of the exponent.

- E.g. If $H = (\mathbb{Z}, +)$, then $H = \langle 1 \rangle$.
- E.g. If H is the subgroup of all rotations of an n -gon, then $H = \langle r \rangle$.

2.2.1 Theorems

1. If $H = \langle x \rangle$, then $|H| = |x|$.
2. Let $x \in G$. For $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, if $x^n = x^m = 1$, then $x^d = 1$, where $d = \gcd(m, n)$.
3. Any 2 cyclic groups of the same order are isomorphic.

- If $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ and $\langle x \rangle, \langle y \rangle$ are cyclic groups of order n , the following map is an isomorphism.

$$\begin{aligned}\phi : \langle x \rangle &\rightarrow \langle y \rangle \\ x^k &\mapsto y^k\end{aligned}$$

- If $\langle x \rangle$ is an infinite cyclic group, the following map is a homomorphism. Thus for each $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, let Z_n be the cyclic group of order n .

$$\begin{aligned}\phi : \mathbb{Z} &\rightarrow \langle x \rangle \\ k &\mapsto x^k\end{aligned}$$

4. Let G be a map, $x \in G$, and $a \in \mathbb{Z} - \{0\}$.

- If $|x| = \infty$, then $|x^a| = \infty$
- If $|x| = n < \infty$, then $|x^a| = n / \gcd(n, a)$

5. Let $H = \langle x \rangle$.

- If $|x| = \infty$, then $H = \langle x \rangle$ iff. $a = \pm 1$.
- If $|x| = n < \infty$, then $H = \langle x^a \rangle$ iff. $\gcd(a, n) = 1$. The number of generators of H is $\phi(n)$.
- E.g. $\bar{a}$ generates $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ iff. $(\bar{a}, n) = 1$. So $\bar{1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{11}$ are generators of $\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z}$, and these are all the $\phi(12) = 4$ generators.

6. Let $H = \langle x \rangle$ be a cyclic group. Then

- Every subgroup of H is cyclic.
- If $|H| = \infty$, then for any non-negative and distinct $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\langle x^a \rangle = \langle x^b \rangle$.
- If $|H| = n < \infty$, then for each $a \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ such that $a|n$, there's a unique subgroup of order a . This is the cyclic group $\langle x^d \rangle$, where $d = n/a$.

2.3 Subgroups Generated by Subsets

If $\mathcal{A}$ is any nonempty collection of subgroups of G , the intersection of all $\mathcal{A}$ is also a subgroup of G .

$$K = \bigcap_{H \in \mathcal{A}} H \quad \text{is a group if} \quad H \leq G$$

If A is a subset of the group G , let the **subgroup of G generated by A** be

$$\langle A \rangle = \bigcap_{A \subseteq H, H \leq G} H$$

I.e. the intersection of all subgroups of G containing A . Equivalently,

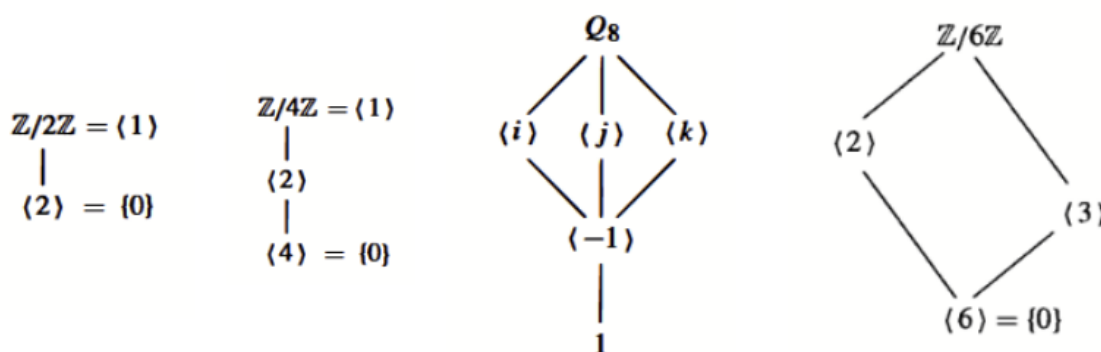
$$\langle A \rangle = \{a_1^{\alpha_1} a_2^{\alpha_2} \cdots a_n^{\alpha_n} \mid \forall i, a_i \in A, \alpha_i \in \mathbb{Z}, a_i \neq a_{i+1} \text{ and } n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$$

An Abelian group G simplifies this a bit:

$$\langle A \rangle = \{a_1^{\alpha_1} a_2^{\alpha_2} \cdots a_n^{\alpha_n} \mid \forall i \text{ and } \alpha_i \in \mathbb{Z}\}$$

- Without an Abelian structure, determining the generated subgroup becomes difficult. E.g. if $G = D_8$, let r, s be the generators. Let $a = s, b = rs$ so that $G = \langle a, b \rangle$. Thus G is generated by 2 elements of order 2, but has order 8.
- Or for $G = S_n = \langle (1\ 2), (1\ 2\ 3\ \dots\ n) \rangle$. Generated by elements of order 2 and n , but has order $n!$

Lattice diagrams can help illuminate the structure of groups and subgroups. Build up from $\{0\}$ at the bottom, and draw subgroups of increasingly higher order upwards. This is helpful to see, for example, the smallest subgroup of G , $\langle H, K \rangle$, containing two smaller subgroups $H \leq G$ and $K \leq G$.

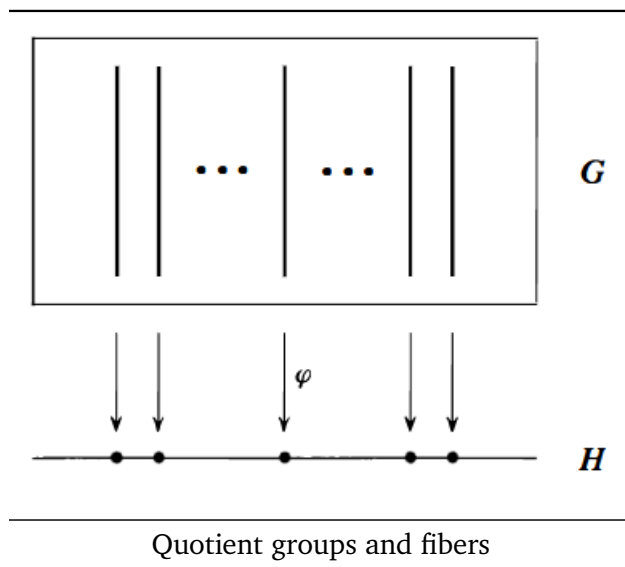


Subgroup examples

3 Quotient Groups and Homomorphisms

3.1 Definitions

Quotient groups are a way to obtain a smaller group from a group G .



$\phi : G \rightarrow H$ is a homomorphism from G to H , i.e. $\phi(xy) = \phi(x)\phi(y)$ for $x, y \in G$. Vertical lines above each point $h \in H$ represent the **fiber of ϕ over h** .

Denote the **kernel of ϕ** as the set

$$\ker \phi = \{g \in G \mid \phi(g) = 1_H\}$$

Let K be the kernel. The **quotient group/factor group** G/K (" $G \bmod K$ ") is a group whose elements are the fibers of ϕ .

For any subgroup $N \leq G$ and $g \in G$, define

$$\text{Left coset of } N \text{ in } G: gN = \{gn \mid n \in N\}$$

$$\text{Right coset of } N \text{ in } G: Ng = \{ng \mid n \in N\}$$

Call any element of a coset the **representative** of that coset. The fibers of a homomorphism $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ are the left or right cosets of the kernel (it may help to think of this graphically). The elements of G/K are the left cosets gK or the right cosets Kg with $g \in G$.

3.2 Theorems

3.2.1 Quotient Groups from Kernel

Theorem 1: Let $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ be a homomorphism. Then

1. $\phi(1_G) = 1_H$
2. $\phi(g^{-1}) = \phi(g)^{-1}$
3. $\phi(g^n) = \phi(g)^n$
4. Kernel of ϕ is a subgroup of G : $\ker \phi \leq G$
5. Image of G under ϕ is a subgroup of H : $\text{im}(\phi) \leq H$

Proof: For (1), $\phi(1_G) = \phi(1_G 1_G) = 1_H 1_H$. For (2), $\phi(g)\phi(g^{-1}) = \phi(gg^{-1}) = \phi(1_G) = 1_H$. Then (3) follows from induction.

For (4), note that $1_G \in \ker \phi$, so $\ker \phi$ is nonempty. Let $x, y \in \ker \phi$. Then $\ker \phi$ satisfies the subgroup criterion:

$$\phi(xy^{-1}) = \phi(x)\phi(y)^{-1} = 1_H$$

Similarly for (5), note that $\phi(1_G) = 1_H$, so the identity of H lies in $\text{im}(\phi)$. If $x, y \in \text{im}(\phi)$ with $\phi(a) = x$ and $\phi(b) = y$, then $\text{im}(\phi)$ satisfies the subgroup criterion:

$$\begin{aligned} xy^{-1} &= \phi(a)\phi(b)^{-1} = \phi(ab^{-1}) \\ xy^{-1} &\in \text{im}(\phi) \end{aligned}$$

Definition: Let $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ with kernel K . Then the **quotient group** G/K is the group whose elements are fibers of ϕ with group operations defined such that: if X is the fiber above a and Y is the fiber above b , then $X \cdot Y$ is the fiber above ab .

Thus $K \in G/K$. Other elements of G/K are “translations” of K .

Theorem 2: Let $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ be a homomorphism with kernel K . Let $X \in G/K$ be a fiber above a , i.e. $X = \phi^{-1}(a)$. Then

- 1) $\forall u \in X, X = \{uk \mid k \in K\}$
- 2) $\forall u \in X, X = \{ku \mid k \in K\}$

Proof: First show $uK \subseteq X$, then $X \subseteq uK$. Similarly for Ku .

What this shows is that the fibers of a homomorphism are the left (or right) cosets of the kernel. Furthermore, the specific value of u doesn't matter, as long as $u \in X$. This is why u is called the “representative.”

Theorem 3: Let K be the kernel of $\phi : G \rightarrow H$. The set of left cosets of G with operation defined as

$$uK \cdot vK = (uv)K$$

form the quotient group G/K . Similarly for right cosets.

E.g. for $\phi : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_n$, the cosets are $a + n\mathbb{Z}$ and the kernel is $n\mathbb{Z}$. Thus the fibers $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ form a group.

In essence, to find a quotient group:

1. Find homomorphism ϕ from group G .
2. Find kernel K of homomorphism.
3. G/K , the fibers of ϕ , is a group

3.2.2 Quotient Groups from Normal Subgroups

We can form a group from a subgroup N iff. N is the kernel of some homomorphism. To determine whether N is a kernel of such a homomorphism, check whether N is a normal subgroup: $N \trianglelefteq G$.

Theorem: For a subgroup N of G , i.e. $N \leq G$, the following are equivalent conditions.

1. $N \trianglelefteq G$
2. $N_G(N) = G$
3. $gN = Ng, \quad \forall g \in G$
4. $gNg^{-1} \subseteq N, \quad \forall g \in G$

Theorem: $N \leq G$ is normal iff. it's the kernel of some homomorphism.

Proof: If N is the kernel of some homomorphism, its left and right cosets are equal (both are fibers of ϕ). By the previous theorem, if $gN = Ng$ for all $g \in G$ is equivalent to $N \trianglelefteq G$.

In the opposite direction, assume $N \trianglelefteq G$ and let $\pi : G \rightarrow G/N$ with $\pi(g) = gN$. Then

$$\pi(g_1g_2) = g_1g_2N = (g_1N)(g_2N) = \pi(g_1)\pi(g_2)$$

so π is a homomorphism. The kernel is $\ker \pi = \{g \in G \mid gN = 1N\} = N$, the normal subgroup.

For $N \trianglelefteq G$, the homomorphism $\pi : G \rightarrow G/N$ defined by $\pi(g) = gN$ is the **natural projection homomorphism**.

Thus an easy way to see whether a subgroup $N \leq G$ is a kernel of some homomorphism is to check whether $N_g(N) = G$. Then we can find the quotient group G/N .

Note that in an Abelian group, any subgroup $N \leq G$ is normal, so any $N \leq G$ can be used to create a quotient group G/N .

3.3 Lagrange's Theorem

3.3.1 Statement

Theorem: The left cosets of $N \leq G$ form a partition of G , and $uN = vN$ iff. u, v are representatives of the same coset.

Lagrange's Theorem: If G is a finite group and $H \leq G$, then $|H|$ divides $|G|$. The number of left cosets of H in G is $|G|/|H|$.

Proof: Let $|H| = n$ and k be the number of left cosets of H in G . For some $g \in G$, define $\phi : H \rightarrow gH$ with $\phi(h) = gh$. ϕ is both injective and surjective, so $|gH| = |H| = n$. From the previous theorem, the cosets partition G , so $|G| = k|H| = kn$. Thus $|G|/|H| = k$.

If $H \leq G$, the number of left cosets of H in G is called the **index** of H in G , denoted $|G : H|$.

- E.g. $\{0\} \in \mathbb{Z}$ has infinite index.
- E.g. $\langle n \rangle \in \mathbb{Z}$ has index n .

3.3.2 Corollaries

Corollary 1: If $x \in G$ and $|G|$ is finite, then $|x|$ divides $|G|$, i.e. $x^{|G|} = 1$.

Proof: $|x| = |\langle x \rangle|$. Let $H = \langle x \rangle$. Then $H \leq G$ so $|H| = |x|$ divides $|G|$.

Corollary 2: If $|G|$ is prime, then G is cyclic and $G \cong Z_p$.

Proof: Let $x \in G$ and $x \neq 1$. Then $|\langle x \rangle| \geq 1$. $\langle x \rangle \in G$, so $|\langle x \rangle|$ divides $|G|$. But $|G|$ is prime, so $|G| = |\langle x \rangle|$. Hence G is cyclic with order p .

Corollary 3: Let $H \leq G$ and $|G : H| = 2$. Then $H \trianglelefteq G$.

Proof: Let $g \in G - H$. The two left cosets of H in G are $1H$ and gH . They partition G , so $gH = G - H$. Similarly, $Hg = g - H$. Then $gH = Hg$, so H must be a normal subgroup of G .

- E.g. $\langle i \rangle = \{i, -1, -i, +1\}$, which has order 4. Q_8 has order 8, so $|Q_8 : \langle i \rangle| = 2$. Thus $\langle i \rangle \trianglelefteq Q_8$.

3.3.3 Cauchy's Theorem and Sylow's Theorem

The converse to Lagrange's theorem isn't true generally: just because n divides G doesn't mean there exists $H \leq G$ with $|H| = n$.

There are some partial converses:

Cauchy's Theorem: If G is finite, and there exists a prime p dividing $|G|$, then G has an element of order p .

Sylow's Theorem: If G is a finite group of order $p^\alpha m$, where p is prime and doesn't divide m , then G has a subgroup of order p^α .

3.3.4 Applications: Fermat's Little Theorem, Euler's Theorem

Lagrange's theorem provides an elegant way to prove these (seemingly number-theoretic) theorems.

Fermat's Little Theorem: If p is prime, then $a^p \equiv a \pmod{p}$ for all $a \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Proof: Define the multiplicative group modulo p , i.e. $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$. For all $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ (with operation being multiplication mod p), $\langle a \rangle \in (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Thus $|a| = |\langle a \rangle|$ must divide $p - 1$, so $a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$.

Euler's Theorem: For all a relatively prime to n , $a^{\phi(n)} \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, where ϕ is the Euler totient function.

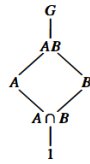
Proof: Define the multiplicative group mod n , $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Also define the multiplicative group mod n of elements *relatively prime* to n , $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^*$. Then $|(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^*| = \phi(n)$. Let a be relatively prime to n , so $a \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^*$. Then all powers of a are also relatively prime to n , so $\langle a \rangle \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^*$.

Use Lagrange's theorem to see that $|a| = |\langle a \rangle|$ must divide $\phi(n)$. Thus $a^{\phi(n)} \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$.

3.4 Isomorphism Theorems

1st Isomorphism Theorem: If $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ is a homomorphism, then $\ker \phi \trianglelefteq G$ and $G/\ker \phi \cong \phi(G)$.

2nd Isomorphism Theorem: Let $A, B \leq G$ and $A \leq N_G(B)$. Then $AB \leq G$, $B \trianglelefteq AB$, $A \cap B \trianglelefteq A$, and $AB/B \cong A/A \cap B$.



Lattice diagram of 2nd isomorphism theorem

3rd Isomorphism Theorem: Let $H, K \trianglelefteq G$ with $H \leq K$. Then $K/H \trianglelefteq G/H$ and

$$(G/H)/(K/H) \cong G/K$$

4th Isomorphism Theorem: Let $N \trianglelefteq G$. There's a bijection from the set of subgroups $A \leq G$ containing N onto the set of subgroups A/N of G/N .

I.e. every subgroup of G/N is of the form A/N for some $A \leq G$ containing N .

3.5 The Hölder Program

3.5.1 Composition Series

Call G a **simple group** if $|G| > 1$ and the only normal subgroups of G are 1 and G .

The sequence

$$1 = N_0 \leq N_1 \leq N_2 \leq \cdots \leq N_{k-1} \leq N_k = G$$

is called a **composition series** if $N_i \trianglelefteq N_{i+1}$ and N_{i+1}/N_i is a simple group. The quotient groups N_{i+1}/N_i are **composition factors** of G .

E.g. for the dihedral group D_8 ,

$$\begin{aligned} 1 \trianglelefteq \langle s \rangle \trianglelefteq \langle s, r^2 \rangle \trianglelefteq D_8 \\ 1 \trianglelefteq \langle r^2 \rangle \trianglelefteq \langle r \rangle \trianglelefteq D_8 \end{aligned}$$

3.5.2 Hölder Program

Jordan-Hölder Theorem: Let G be a finite group with $|G| > 1$. Then G has a composition series, and the composition factors are unique up to a permutation.

This suggests the **Hölder program**:

1. Classify all finite groups
2. Find all ways of combining two groups into one.

Theorem: There are 18 infinite simple group families and 26 simple groups not in those families (sporadic simple groups), such that every finite simple group is isomorphic to 1 in this list.

Feit-Thompson Theorem: If G is a simple group of odd order, then $G \cong Z_p$ for some prime p .

Proof: Both are trivial.

We call G **solvable** if it has the composition

$$1 = G_0 \trianglelefteq G_1 \trianglelefteq G_2 \trianglelefteq \cdots \trianglelefteq G_s = G$$

where G_{i+1}/G_i is Abelian.

3.6 The Alternating Group A_n

Call a 2-cycle $(i\ j)$ a **transposition**. Every element of S_n can be written as a product of transpositions.

Define the polynomial Δ and the permutation σ such that

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta &= \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq n} (x_i - x_j) \\ \sigma(\Delta) &= \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq n} (x_{\sigma(i)} - x_{\sigma(j)}) \end{aligned}$$

Since σ is a bijection, only a few terms $(x_{\sigma(i)} - x_{\sigma(j)})$ get their signs switched, so $\sigma(\Delta) = \pm\Delta$. Define ϵ such that

$$\epsilon(\sigma) = \begin{cases} +1 & \sigma(\Delta) = \Delta \\ -1 & \sigma(\Delta) = -\Delta \end{cases}$$

- E.g. for $\sigma = (1\ 2\ 3\ 4)$, we have $(1\ 2\ 3\ 4)(\Delta) = (-1)^3(\Delta)$, so $\epsilon((1\ 2\ 3\ 4)) = -1$. This is **not** the Levi-Civita symbol.
- $\epsilon(\sigma)$ is called the **sign** of σ .
- σ is an even permutation if $\epsilon(\sigma) = +1$, odd if $\epsilon(\sigma) = -1$.
- The map $\epsilon : S_n \rightarrow \{\pm 1\}$ is a homomorphism.

Theorem: transpositions $(i\ j)$ are all odd permutations.

Proof: Note that $\epsilon((1\ 2)) = -1$ since it only flips $(x_1 - x_2)$. For a general $(i\ j)$, let λ be the permutation exchanging 1 and i , 2 and j . Then $(i\ j) = \lambda(1\ 2)\lambda$. ϵ is a homomorphism, so

$$\epsilon((i\ j)) = \epsilon(\lambda(1\ 2)\lambda) = \epsilon(\lambda)^2\epsilon((1\ 2)) = -1$$

Define A_n , the **alternating group of degree n** , to be the kernel of ϵ . I.e. the set of even permutations. $S_n - A_n$ is the set of odd permutations.

By the 1st isomorphism theorem, $S_n/\ker \epsilon \cong \{\pm 1\}$, and by Lagrange's theorem, $|A_n| = n!/2$. A_n will become useful in the study of polynomials.

4 Group Actions

4.1 Definitions

Let G be a group acting on set A . For all $g \in G$, the map $\sigma_g : A \rightarrow A$ defined by $\sigma_g : a \mapsto g \cdot a$ is a permutation of A .

For each action of G on A , there's an associated homomorphism $\phi : G \rightarrow S_A$ defined by $\phi(g) = \sigma_g$, called the **permutation representation** associated with a given action.

- Kernel of action: $\{g \in G \mid g \cdot a = a, \forall a \in A\}$
- Stabilizer of a in G : $G_a = \{g \in G \mid g \cdot a = a\}$
- An action is **faithful** if the kernel is the identity.

A **permutation representation** of G is any homomorphism of G into the symmetric group S_A for some nonempty set A .

- Given any nonempty set A and homomorphism $\phi : G \rightarrow S_A$, the action of G on A can be $g \cdot a = \phi(g)(a)$. The kernel of this action is the same as the kernel of ϕ .

Let G act on set A . The relation on A defined by $a \sim b$ iff. $a = g \cdot b$ for some $g \in G$ is an **equivalence relation**. The **equivalence class** is $\mathcal{C}_a = \{g \cdot a \mid g \in G\}$. Alternatively, the **orbit of G containing a** .

- The orbit of a : set of all elements a can move to under a group action.
- $|\mathcal{C}_a| = |G : G_a|$, index of stabilizer a
- Action of G on A is **transitive** if there's only 1 orbit. I.e. for all $a, b \in A$, there exists $g \in G$ such that $a = g \cdot b$.

Cayley's Theorem: Every group is isomorphic to a subgroup of some symmetric group. If G has order n , then G is isomorphic to a subgroup of S_n .

Proof: Let G be a group, and let A be the set of left cosets of $1 \in G$. Let G act by left multiplication on A . The homomorphism $\pi : G \rightarrow S_G$ is that of a group action. The kernel of π is

$$\begin{aligned} \ker \pi &= \{g \in G \mid gx1 = x1 \quad \forall x \in G\} \\ &= \{1\} \end{aligned}$$

Thus π is an isomorphism.

4.2 Groups Acting on Themselves by Conjugation

4.2.1 Definitions

Let G act on $A = G$ through conjugation, such that

$$g \cdot a = gag^{-1}, \quad \forall g, a \in G$$

$a, b \in G$ are conjugate in G if there exists a $g \in G$ such that $b = g \cdot a = gag^{-1}$. I.e. if a and b are in the same orbit of G acting on itself by conjugation. These orbits are called the **conjugacy classes** of G .

- For an Abelian group, the conjugacy class of each $g \in G$ is $\{g\}$.
- Subsets $S, T \subseteq G$ are conjugate in G if there exists a $g \in G$ such that $T = gSg^{-1}$. I.e. if S, T are in the same orbit of G acting on itself by conjugation.

For $S \subseteq G$, if G acts on S with $g \cdot a = gag^{-1}, \forall a \in S$, the number of elements in the orbit/equivalence class containing S is $|G : G_S|$.

$$G_S = \{g \in G \mid gSg^{-1} = S\} = N_G(S)$$

- The number of conjugates of a subset $S \subseteq G$ is the index of the normalizer of S , i.e. $|G : N_G(S)|$.
- The number of conjugates of an element $s \in G$ is the index of the centralizer of s , i.e. $|G : C_G(s)|$.

The Class Equation: Let G be a finite group, and let $g_1, g_2, \dots, g_r$ be the representatives of distinct conjugacy classes of G not contained in the center $Z(G)$. Then

$$|G| = |Z(G)| + \sum_{i=1}^r |G : C_G(g_i)|$$

Corollary: If P is a group of prime power p^α for some $\alpha \geq 1$, then P has a nontrivial center $Z(P) \neq 1$.

Proof: By the class equation,

$$|P| = |Z(P)| + \sum_{i=1}^r |P : C_P(g_i)|$$

and by assumption, $C_P(g_i)$ is non-central, so $|C_P(g_i)| \neq |P|$. p divides $|P : C_P(g_i)|$, so p must divide $|Z(P)|$ and $|Z(P)| \neq 1$.

4.2.2 Conjugacy in Symmetric Groups

Let $\sigma, \tau \in S_n$ and let σ have the cycle decomposition $(a_1 a_2 \dots a_{k_1})(b_1 b_2 \dots b_{k_2}) \dots$. Then $\tau\sigma\tau^{-1}$ has the cycle decomposition

$$(\tau(a_1) \tau(a_2) \dots \tau(a_{k_1})) (\tau(b_1) \tau(b_2) \dots \tau(b_{k_2})) \dots$$

Proof: If $\sigma(i) = j$, then $\tau\sigma\tau^{-1}(\tau(i)) = \tau(j)$. Thus if i, j appears in the cycle decomposition of σ , then $\tau(i), \tau(j)$ appears in the cycle decomposition of τ .

If $\sigma \in S_n$ is the product of disjoint cycles of length $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_r$ with $n_1 \leq n_2 \leq \dots \leq n_r$, then $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_r$ are the **cycle type** of σ . Two elements of S_n are conjugate iff. they have the same cycle type.

The number of partitions of n equals the number of conjugacy classes of S_n . E.g. for $n = 5$,

Partition of 5	Representative of Conjugacy Class
1, 1, 1, 1, 1	1
1, 1, 1, 2	(1 2)
1, 1, 3	(1 2 3)
1, 4	(1 2 3 4)
5	(1 2 3 4 5)
1, 2, 2	(1 2)(3 4)
2, 3	(1 2)(3 4 5)

4.3 Automorphisms

An isomorphism of G onto itself is called an **automorphism**. The set of all automorphisms of G is $\text{Aut}(G)$.

Let $H \leq G$. Then G acts by conjugation on H as an automorphism of H . I.e. conjugation by $g \in G$ is an automorphism of H . The permutation representation of the homomorphism is $\phi : G \rightarrow \text{Aut}(H)$ with kernel $C_G(H)$.

$$h \mapsto ghg^{-1}, \quad \forall h \in H$$

Let $g \in G$. Conjugation by g is an **inner automorphism** of G , and the subgroup of $\text{Aut}(G)$ containing all inner automorphisms of G is called $\text{Inn}(G)$.

- Note that $\text{Inn}(G) \leq \text{Aut}(G)$, so $\text{Inn}(G) \cong G/Z(G)$.

A subgroup $H \leq G$ is **characteristic in** G , denoted $H \text{ char } G$, if every automorphism of G maps H to itself: $\sigma(H) = H$ for all $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(G)$.

- Characteristic subgroups are normal.
- Although normality isn't transitive, if $K \text{ char } H$ and $H \trianglelefteq G$, then $K \trianglelefteq G$.
- Characteristic subgroups are like “strongly normal” subgroups.

Theorem: For any $H \leq G$, $N_G(H)/C_G(H)$ is isomorphic to a subgroup of $\text{Aut}(H)$. If $H = G$, then this becomes that $G/Z(G)$ is isomorphic to a subgroup of $\text{Aut}(G)$.

Proof: Note that $H \trianglelefteq N_G(H)$. Conjugation by $g \in G$ is an automorphism of H with permutation representation $\phi : N_G(H) \rightarrow \text{Aut}(H)$ with kernel $C_G(H)$. By the 1st isomorphism theorem,

$$N_G(H)/C_G(H) \cong \text{Subgroup of } \text{Aut}(H)$$

Theorem: The automorphism group of cycle groups of order n , Z_n , is isomorphic to $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$, an Abelian group of order $\phi(n)$.

Proof: Let $Z_n = \langle x \rangle$. If $\psi \in \text{Aut}(Z_n)$, then $\psi(x) = x^a$ for some $a \in \mathbb{Z}$. Further, $|x| = n$ so a is defined mod n . We seek to show a bijection between Z_n and $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Define the homomorphism (it can be shown that $\Psi(\psi_a \circ \psi_b) = \Psi(\psi_a) \circ \Psi(\psi_b)$)

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi : \text{Aut}(Z_n) &\rightarrow (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times \\ \psi_a &\mapsto a \pmod{n}, \quad \psi_a \in \Psi \end{aligned}$$

This map is surjective. It is also injective, thus Ψ is an isomorphism.